

GENDER



BENDERS

Rahul Rao vs Priya Phansekar

Find the number of hard drives




3 min
45 sec

A confident Rahul approached the machine with caution. Quickly, he accessed the 'My Computer' folder and pat came his reply: "There are five hard drives on this PC." Sorry, dude, wrong answer. Thrown off balance, Rahul dabbled a bit more with items in the folder. Next, he entered "dxdiag" in the 'Run' dialog box, but the DirectX Diagnostic Tool box that opened did not help. Eventually, realisation dawned and he figured there's only one HDD, but it was all too late.




2 min
10 sec

A computer engineering student, Priya seemed eager to begin. She too clicked open 'My Computer' and saw: Local Disk (C:), Work (E:), Applications (F:), Dump-1 (G:) and Dump-2 (H:). Fact is, of all the drives listed, the only hard drive was (C:) while the others were its partitions. An unsure Priya retracted her first answer of "one hard drive" and said there were five. Finally, she set off right: 'My Computer' > 'Manage' and then to Storage > Disk Management. And it showed (C:) as the sole HDD and indicated the rest were partitions. The Winner!

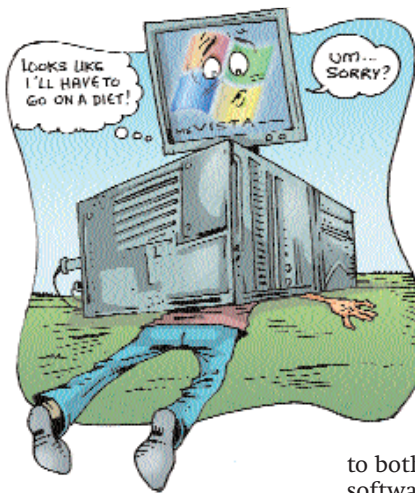
VISTA JINXED?

Hefty Hardware For Vista?

Microsoft's much-talked-about OS, Vista, seems to be in the midst of another brewing controversy.

This time it's about the hefty hardware requirements it may command.

Just weeks after releasing Windows Vista Beta 1, Microsoft has shifted the paradigms again, unveiling a preview of Beta 2 at the TechEd 2005 developer conference. Based on this version, users have ample reason to believe that the community to



benefit the most from this OS would be the hardware vendors.

Nigel Page, a strategist with Microsoft Australia, said Vista would work best on a video card with more than 256 MB of RAM, 2 GB of DDR3 memory and a SATA 2 hard drive. He said, There's a completely new driver model in Vista called the Longhorn Display Driver Model—LDDM.

There has been an explosion in the capabilities of graphics chips - they're almost universally 3D vector graphics now—and the driver model today we have is bitmap. Taking a cue from this, more information was sought and this revealed that only the beefiest of hardware would allow users to get the most from Vista.

Watch this space for more details.

Microsoft is also not committing to applying guidelines it helped develop for trusted computing to Vista, according to noted crypto guru Bruce Schneier.

The Trusted Computing Group (TCG), which includes Microsoft, Sony, AMD, Intel, IBM, Sun and HP, has developed a set of guidelines (Design, Implementation, and Usage Principles for Trusted Platform Module-Based Platforms), which Schneier argues are equally applicable

to both hardware and software platforms.

But Microsoft is resisting the application of these ideas to Vista, argues Schneier.

Meanwhile, there have also been rumours about the release date, which is now being pegged as December 7, 2006. This rumour is claimed to be based on very recent internal Microsoft documentation.

It also said the first release candidate of the operating system, RC0, will appear on 19 April, 2006, with the second release candidate due on 28 June, 2006.

BID TO TALK!

eBay Buys Out Skype

Online auction site eBay agreed to acquire Internet telephony company Skype Technologies for \$2.6 billion (Rs 90 billion), the companies announced in late September. The deal will help eBay move into new business areas while

Beta

Back in December 2004, Robert Scoble of Microsoft Basked on his blog, "Does 'Beta' mean anything anymore?" Well, does it? We all know what 'Beta' is supposed to mean—it's the final testing stage of a product before the official version is rolled out. So why does Google call everything 'Beta'? Google News is still Beta, though we've been using it for quite a while now. Google Catalogs is Beta. Google Groups is Beta. And the

epidemic seems to be spreading. Flickr is still Beta and we've been using it for at least 8-10 months already? Look around you and you'll see a lot of Betas.

We could go on and on. Google's latest offering, which has caused a buzz like all things Google do, is Google Talk. Of course, it's Beta. And we're willing to bet it will be for a long, long time. For that purpose, let's just also say this little snippet is not yet over. It's kinda Beta!

Buzzword
of the MONTH